

improve our process of building better products, but AI will affect every sector—healthcare and education being some examples. As companies around the world think of using AI to transform themselves, I want Google to be their partner. In my vision of how Google is seen over time, it should not be just about some of the best products built for AI but also one of the largest providers of AI.

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You have had considerable success in areas such as Search and Maps. What is the next step in terms of evolution?

These are important products in the world of technology and you have to innovate to make sure they are the best for users. That will continue to be our No. 1 focus. Using AI to innovate only gives us a [launch] pad for the next decade. Equally important is to bring it all in the context of the Cloud. Along the way, there will be newer products—it could be AR glasses or rethinking Google Assistant.

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The potential of the Cloud is beyond doubt, but there is competition in that space. What is your strategy for that?

We have been doing this now for a few years and some of the leading companies have been doing it for much longer. When I look at the pace of our growth, we are obviously investing to reach that scale. I am very pleased with the momentum we are seeing. The areas of comfort are being early in the lifecycle of where the shift will happen. From a technology standpoint, we will definitely lead in some of the areas such as data analytics or cybersecurity or AI. That gives me confidence in the long term. We are very competitive in large deals and we will build it [Cloud] patiently with an eye on the long term.

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Eight of your new languages have come out of India and that opens up the emergence of digitisation in the Tier II and III cities. How do you see Google's enhanced role?

Our mission statement is to make information universally accessible. Therefore, we work hard on the Chromebook. We know it opens up computer access to more people and it explains why we work on affordable smartphones. Language is one aspect and as we opened up services like voice and Google Maps, they became important for access to more and more people. India is one of the leading markets for us globally in terms of voice usage. We know that by investing in voice and doing it well, we are merely opening up access for people to use it in newer ways. I would think about it as, 'What does it take to make our products work really well beyond the main metros?' That [also] helps in the overall digitisation of the country and this is a virtuous cycle.

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You have been working closely with the Government of India. How has the nature of that engagement evolved?

When I see the potential of the digital sector over the long term, I feel very confident

We try and understand the priority of the government to drive progress for a digital India. It is something that has always resonated with us. Google Pay, for instance, was to help that kind of digital transformation. Another area of priority is education and skilling, particularly around reaching rural areas, women and under-represented groups. In the long term, we want to understand the government's priorities on agriculture, healthcare and help where we can. Finally, as a company, we are very focussed on sustainability. We would like to be a partner—and I did mention cybersecurity—where we can provide solutions.

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Globally, regulations are a contentious issue you've had to deal with. What are your thoughts on that and the regulatory structures you have to contend with?

As technology is evolving, every country wants to protect its citizens or have some set of rules for the sector. We view ourselves as an important player and we care about the open connected internet. India is a large consumer and is going to be a large provider. In terms of regulation, we always take a constructive approach. Something like GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) in Europe has been important.

Regulatory certainty allows us to invest clearly. An example is UPI in India which convinced us to invest in Google Pay. What we do should work for society and as a part of that, any regulatory conversation will be done constructively and respectfully with the idea of addressing concerns to make progress. That said, the common benefit of a connected internet and all the opportunities it creates is important.